

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization

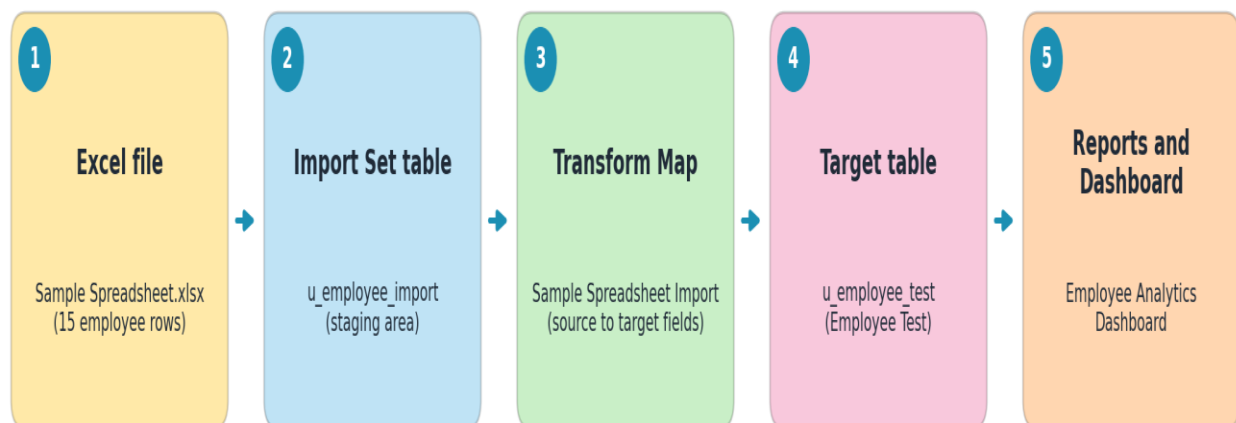
Date	Oct 2 nd 2026
Team ID	6ab8c330c23107aaaa72e953
Project Name	Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
Maximum Marks	

Project detail	Description
Project title	Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
Team ID	6ab8c330c23107aaaa72e953
Date	Oct 2 nd 2026
Session plan	10 minutes to prepare, 1 hour to collaborate

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization :

For this project, the team used the session to decide how to move bulk employee data from an Excel spreadsheet into ServiceNow safely, keep it free of duplicates, and present it in reports and a dashboard.

Project at a glance: Import Data using Transform Maps (ServiceNow)



Coalesce on Employee ID: new ID = insert | existing ID with changes = update | unchanged row = ignore

Figure 1: Overview of the Import Data using Transform Maps project

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

A. Team gathering

Team member	Role in the session	Focus area
Team Lead	Team lead and Import Set lead	Loads the Excel file into the staging table and runs the transform (Phases 3 and 5)
Team Member 2	Table designer	Creates the Employee Test table and its five fields (Phase 2)
Team Member 3	Transform Map and Coalesce specialist	Builds the Transform Map, enables Coalesce and tests re-imports (Phases 4, 6 and 7)
Team Member 4	Reports and dashboard lead	Creates the three reports and the Employee Analytics Dashboard (Phases 8 and 9)
Team Member 5	Data preparation and tester	Prepares the Excel files and checks data quality (Phases 1 and 7)

B. Set the goal

The goal of the session is to find a safe, repeatable way to load employee data from Excel into ServiceNow so that records are accurate, are not duplicated when the same data is imported again, and can be viewed through reports.

C. Define the problem statement

PROBLEM
How might we import bulk employee data from Excel into ServiceNow accurately, without duplicates, and turn it into useful reports?

D. Why this problem matters

- Typing hundreds of employee records by hand is slow and error-prone.
- Importing the same file twice can create duplicate employees.
- Raw rows give no quick view of employees by department or location.

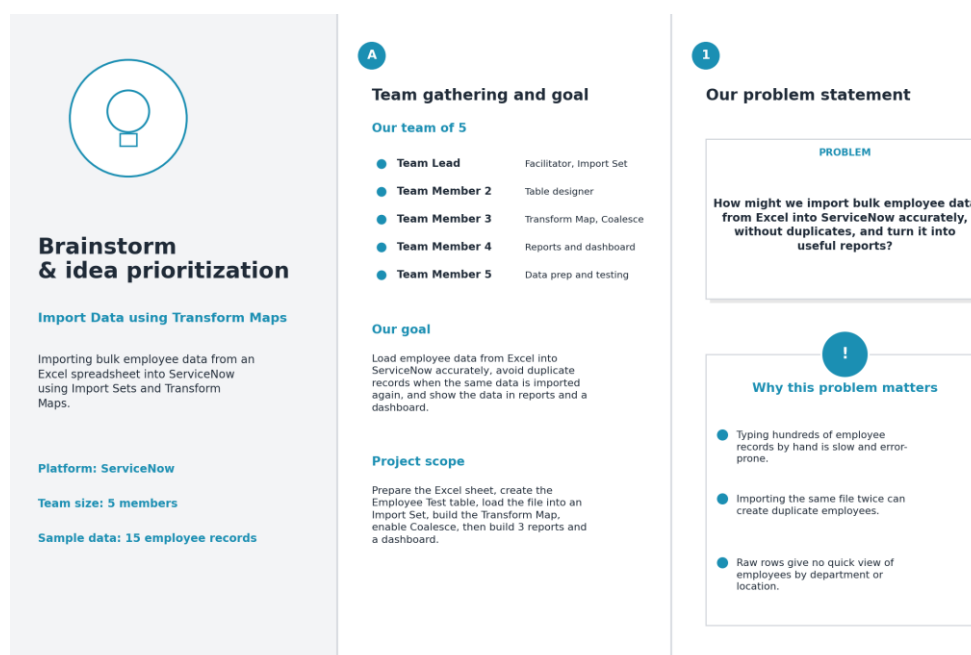


Figure 2: Team gathering, collaboration and problem statement

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

A. Brainstorm

2 Brainstorm

Import Data using Transform Maps



Figure 3: Brainstorm: ideas written by each team member

Team member	Ideas
Team Lead	1) Load Excel into Import Set staging 2) Use Auto Map Matching Fields 3) Run Transform from the Transform Map 4) Check Transform History for results 5) Set Sheet number 1, Header row 1
Team Member 2	1) Create custom table u_employee_test 2) Add 5 String fields in Form Layout 3) Use clear labels: ID, Name, Email 4) Verify new fields on the form 5) Rearrange list columns
Team Member 3	1) Enable Coalesce on Employee ID 2) Re-import changed rows to test updates 3) Insert new IDs, update existing ones 4) Same file again: all rows ignored 5) Stop duplicate employee records
Team Member 4	1) Pie chart: Employees by Department 2) Bar chart: Employees by Location 3) List report of all employees 4) Build Employee Analytics Dashboard 5) Restrict dashboard to roles/groups
Team Member 5	1) Prepare sample data in Google Sheets 2) Download the sheet as .xlsx 3) Keep every Employee ID unique 4) Check emails and names before import 5) Future: schedule automatic imports

B. Group ideas

3 Group ideas

Related ideas were clustered into seven themes that follow the project flow, each with a sentence-style label.

20 minutes

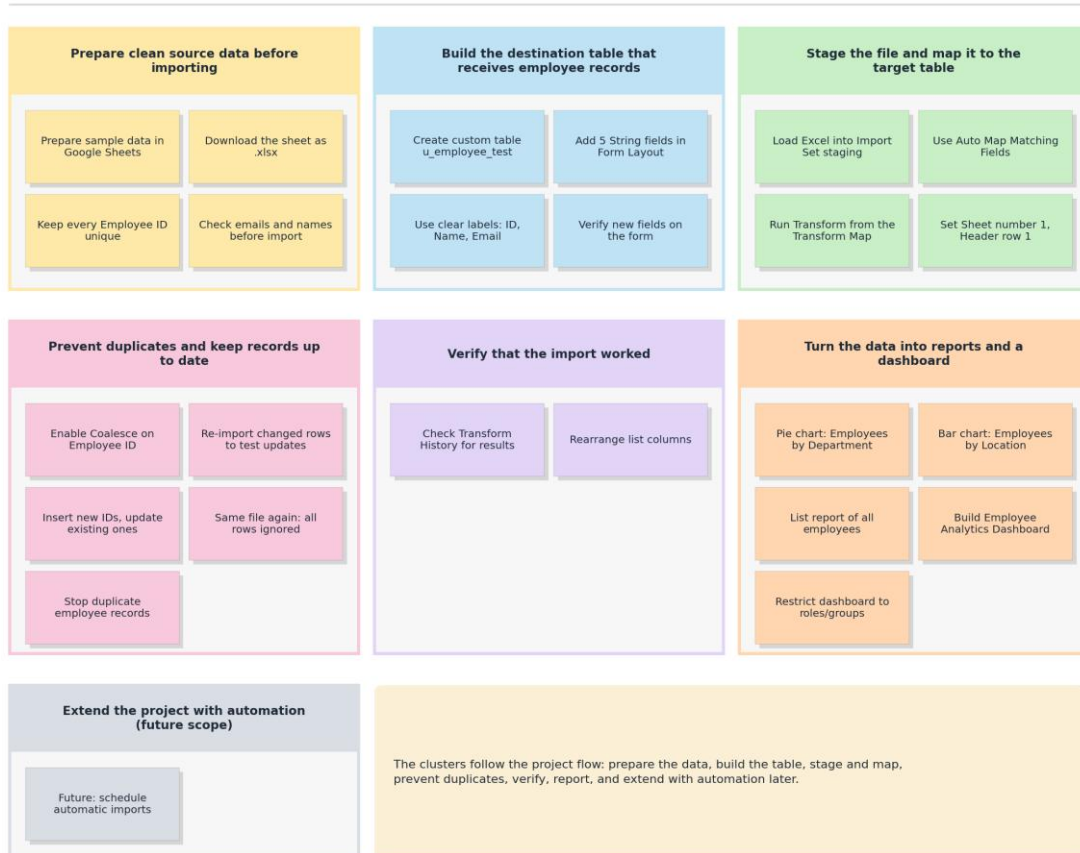


Figure 4: Ideas grouped into seven clusters (20 minutes)

No.	Cluster label	Ideas in the cluster
1	Prepare clean source data before importing	Prepare sample data in Google Sheets; Download the sheet as .xlsx; Keep every Employee ID unique; Check emails and names before import
2	Build the destination table that receives employee records	Create custom table u_employee_test; Add 5 String fields in Form Layout; Use clear labels: ID, Name, Email; Verify new fields on the form
3	Stage the file and map it to the target table	Load Excel into Import Set staging; Use Auto Map Matching Fields; Run Transform from the Transform Map; Set Sheet number 1, Header row 1
4	Prevent duplicates and keep records up to date	Enable Coalesce on Employee ID; Re-import changed rows to test updates; Insert new IDs, update existing ones; Same file again: all rows ignored; Stop duplicate employee records
5	Verify that the import worked	Check Transform History for results; Rearrange list columns
6	Turn the data into reports and a dashboard	Pie chart: Employees by Department; Bar chart: Employees by Location; List report of all employees; Build Employee Analytics Dashboard; Restrict dashboard to roles/groups
7	Extend the project with automation (future scope)	Future: schedule automatic imports

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

4 Prioritize

Project ideas rated by importance to the project and feasibility for the team.

20 minutes



Figure 5: Importance versus feasibility grid (20 minutes)

No.	Idea	Importance	Feasibility	Decision
1	Stage the Excel file in an Import Set table	Very high	Very high	Do first
2	Create the custom target table (u_employee_test)	High	Very high	Do first
3	Build the Transform Map with auto-mapped fields	Very high	High	Do first
4	Enable Coalesce on Employee ID	Very high	High	Do first
5	Prepare clean, unique Excel data	High	Very high	Do first
6	Verify results using Transform History	Medium	High	Do next
7	Create 3 reports (pie, bar, list)	Medium	High	Do next
8	Build the Employee Analytics Dashboard	High	Medium	Do next
9	Restrict dashboard access by role/group	Low	High	Do later
10	Schedule automatic imports (future scope)	High	Low	Do later

Outcome of the prioritization

- **Do first (ideas 1 to 5):** prepare clean Excel data, create the Employee Test table, stage the file in an Import Set, build the Transform Map and enable Coalesce on Employee ID. These form the core of the project because they decide whether the data is imported correctly and without duplicates.
- **Do next (ideas 6 to 8):** check results in Transform History, create the three reports and build the Employee Analytics Dashboard. These make the imported data easy to verify and understand.
- **Do later (ideas 9 and 10):** restrict dashboard access by role or group, and schedule automatic imports. These are valuable extensions but need more effort, so they are kept as future scope.

The team agreed to move forward with ideas 1 to 8 as the scope of the project and to record ideas 9 and 10 as possible enhancements.